sadr,[2] one of the seven brothers who served Babur was attacked from the rear. The nape of his neck was pierced, and he died on the spot. Babur remembered him in his memoir as an ‘excellent soldier’. He was a close aide of Babur’s father and cherished the responsibility of being the seal’s keeper. Khwajaki was an expert in Islamic theology, a wordsmith with an eloquent style. Babur further romanticizes his mysticism by stating that he could invoke rain by using a jade stone.

The small battle was over. While Babur was still in Yam along with his men, Hubbub, one of his generals, rose with his subordinates and plundered all the traders in the vicinity. This disappointed Babur big time, and he instructed the general to return every plundered penny. The trade of respectful return happened in the first watch of the next day itself. Not a single tag of cotton, not even a broken needle’s point remained in the possession of this Tīmūrid army of Babur, and all reached back to the hands of respective owners.

They had begun to march away from Yam. When Samarkand was just six miles away, they decided to take a break and work on preparing themselves for the campaigns ahead. They camped in Timur’s old avenue for around seven weeks. This period saw small skirmishes from both sides.

While they stayed there, an afternoon a message was delivered. It read, ‘Come you tonight to the *Lovers’ Cave* side and we will give you the fort.’ This left young Babur highly excited and the capture looked like a kid’s job to him. Unaware of what was waiting in the stock, he along with his few men went to the Maghnak bridge that night and then sent a party, including men on horse and foot to the rendezvous. Around half a dozen of household foot soldiers went forward as the nuisance began to fall upon them. One among them was known as Haji and had served Babur from his infancy. None could remain alive in the adventure of aspiration.

Babur addressed it as a message of deceit in the *Baburnama*.

The night ended in sourness for Babur.

A few days passed. The Samarkandis came out and began to assemble around them shaping almost like a town. Suddenly, men from all the forts, except the main one in Samarkand came on to attack Babur and his associates. As expected, Babur’s men decided not to let them be at much peace and replied with much more vigour. The untrained attackers had no chance against Babur’s brave and trained men. They could not maintain